

“If ... [he] remains **obdurate**, we must **face the possibility** that **Diem** himself cannot be **preserved**.”

ASSISTANT SECRETARY OF STATE ROGER HILSMAN IN THE “HILSMAN CABLE,” AUGUST 24, 1963

» AFTER

Diem’s assassination left South Vietnam’s future more uncertain. In many ways, his removal only made the situation worse.

REVOLVING DOOR

Between 1963 and 1965, there were 12 different governments in the South as coup followed coup. The Viet Cong was quick to take advantage of this **and mounted a series of attacks**. In June 1965, ARVN General Nguyen Van Thieu became **president of South Vietnam** and remained so for the next 10 years.

DETERMINED LEADER

Lyndon B. Johnson took over as President of the United States. One of his first acts was to **reaffirm US commitment** to South Vietnam. He told a group of his closest advisers that he was not going to lose Vietnam and would not be the president who saw Southeast Asia go the same way as China.